Design Explanation: Personal Academic Portfolio

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Course: CS381 – Web Application Development

1. Design Concept and Color Palette

The portfolio is designed with a professional academic aesthetic, utilizing a minimalist color scheme: **White (#FFFFFF)**, **Sky Blue (#0984e3)**, and **Light Grey (#f5f7fa)**. This palette was selected to ensure visual clarity and a modern user interface that emphasizes the academic content without distractions.

2. Layout Strategy (CSS Grid and Flexbox)

The website's structure demonstrates a hybrid layout approach to satisfy modern web standards:

- **CSS Grid:** Utilized for the primary page structure (main layout). It allows for a dynamic shifting of content from a single-column stack on mobile devices to a multi-column grid on larger screens.
- **Flexbox:** Applied to smaller components such as the navigation menu (to center links and manage spacing) and the "Interests" section (to allow hobby tags to flow and wrap naturally).

3. Mobile-First and Responsive Design

Following the **Mobile-First** methodology, the CSS was initially written to optimize the experience for smartphones. Media Queries (`@media min-width: 768px`) were then implemented to scale the layout for tablets and desktops, ensuring a seamless experience across all device types without the use of external frameworks like Bootstrap.

4. Semantic HTML5 and Structure

To enhance the document's structure and SEO, semantic HTML5 elements were used exclusively, including `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<section>`, and `<footer>`. This provides a clear hierarchy and meaningful organization of the content across the three mandatory pages (Home, Profile, and Contact).

5. Accessibility Considerations

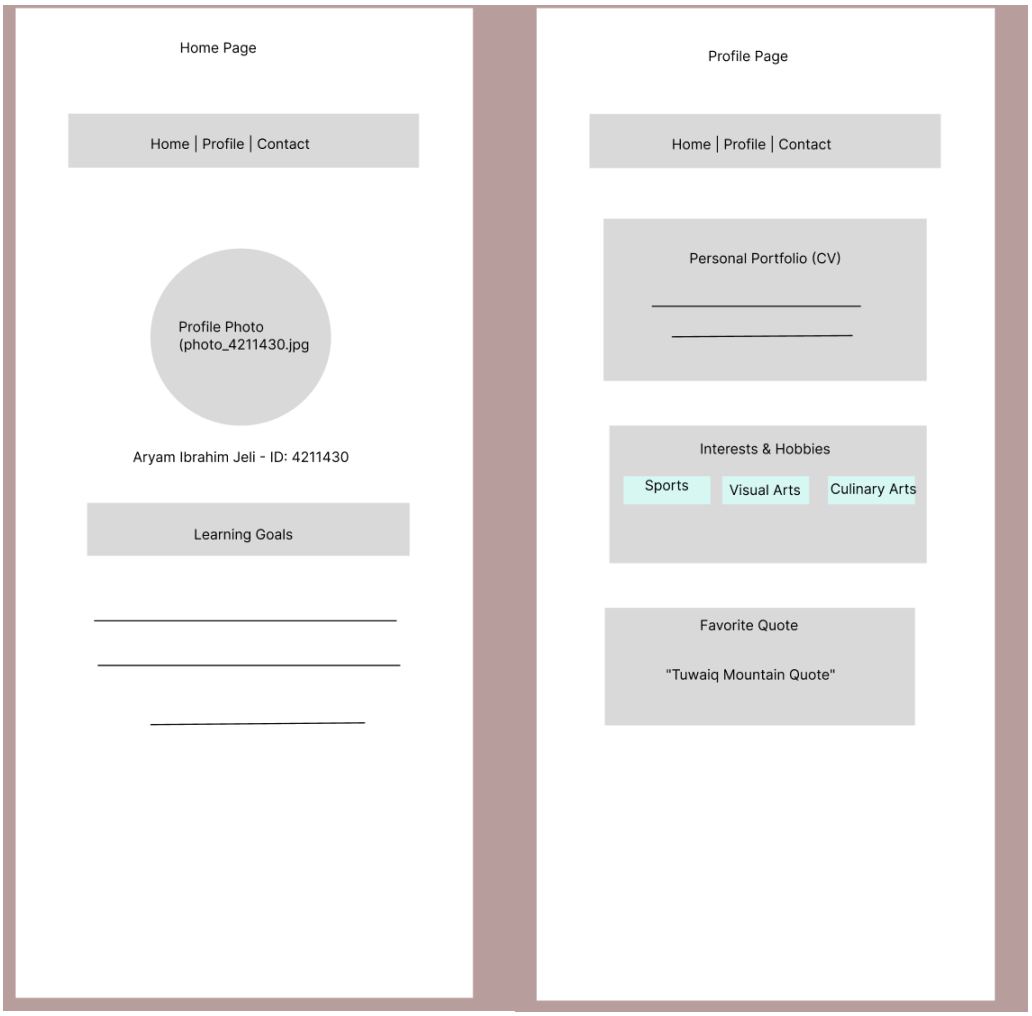
Accessibility was a core priority in this design:

- **Alt Text:** All images, including the profile photo (`photo_4211430.jpg`), include descriptive `alt` attributes for screen readers.
- **Color Contrast:** High contrast between the text and background colors was maintained to ensure readability for users with visual impairments.
- **Semantic Tags:** Using proper tags ensures that assistive technologies can navigate the site effectively.

6. Development Workflow (Git and GitHub)

The project was managed using **Git** for version control. Regular commits were made to document the progress of the development, and the final source code was hosted on **GitHub** to facilitate a professional deployment and cloning process.

Wireframe sketch :



Contact Page

Home | Profile | Contact

Contact Information

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